LAF YOMI

Bekhorot 47 · November 04, 2026

ON TODAY'S DAF

Bekhorot 47 presses the convert question to its limit: how far does גר שנתגייר כקטן שנולד דמי reach — for bechorah, peru u'revu, milah and yichud? Then pidyon haben's edges — the leviyah's son, the kohenet, the chalal son of a kohen, the son of uncertain parentage — and the closing mishnah on miscarriage and yotzei dofen.

גר שנתגייר כקטן שנולד דמי · THE MESHECH CHOCHMAH'S SINAI WEDDING



1. The Meshech Chochmah's source for גר שנתגייר כקטן שנולד דמי: before the Torah, a brother and sister could marry — no prohibition existed. Then the Torah forbids it, and Moshe says שובו לכם לאהליכם, go back to your wives.

“How could Moshe say 'go back to your wives' if half the nation was married to a sibling? Only because a convert is like a newborn — halachically, they are no longer brother and sister at all.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 47a · היו לו בנים בגיותו — the convert as a newborn child · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 4:23

פריה ורביה · THE TUREI EVEN'S SHOTEH



2. The Turei Even asks how a convert fulfils peru u'revu with children from before: he wasn't obligated then. He compares it to a shoteh on Pesach night, who eats matzah while not sane, then recovers — and must eat again.

“Peru u'revu is different: it is result-oriented. The Torah wants children to exist — and the children exist. The shoteh eats again; the convert's children already count.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 47a · קיים פריה ורביה — the shoteh who ate matzah · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 14:54

כהן שמת · THE KOHEN WHO PAID HIMSELF



3. A kohen married a divorcee and died, leaving a chalal son. If the father died after the boy was thirty days old, all agree the son need not redeem himself — שהרי זכה אב בפדיונו.

“What would the father have done alive? Kept the pidyon money for himself — he is a kohen. The kohen redeems his own son and pockets the five selaim.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 47b · כהן שמת — the father who kept his own pidyon money · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 40:44

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מי שלא שהתה · THE INHERITANCE RUNAROUND



4. A woman remarried without waiting three months, and nobody knows whether her son is the first husband's (nine months) or the second's (seven). He is a bechor for pidyon but not for yerushah — yet the Gemara says he takes a plain share. How?

“Go to the first husband's heirs — 'You're the second's son.' Go to the second's — 'You're the first's.' Hamotzi meichaveiro alav hare'ayah: with no proof, he gets nothing — bounced between two families like a letter with no address.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 47b · וכן מי שלא שהתה — neither family will claim him · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 44:59

הרשאה · THE POWER-OF-ATTORNEY WORKAROUND



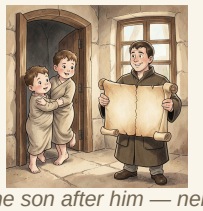
5. The uncertain son and the son after him — one is certainly the bechor — could write each other a harshaah, a power of attorney, and sue for the double portion together: 'If I'm the bechor, it's mine; if you're the bechor, it's yours.'

“Rabbi Yannai shuts it down: harshaah only works if the sons were הוכרו — recognised as bechorim — before they got mixed up. You cannot authorise a right nobody ever had.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 47b · ולכתבו הרשאה להדדי — the power-of-attorney workaround · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 46:17

יוצא דופן · ONE BECHORAH, SPLIT IN TWO



6. The mishnah: a boy born by Cesarean, and the son after him — neither is a bechor, not for yerushah and not for pidyon. The first didn't open the womb; the second isn't the first of his father's strength. Rabbi Shimon splits the bechorah in two.

“The first son is the bechor for yerushah; the second is the bechor for the five selaim. One bechorah, two sons — the Gemara's answer to 'who is the firstborn?' is 'both of you, a little bit.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 47b · יוצא דופן — one bechorah, split in two · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 49:36